

Sony PlayStation Portable

Gaming On The Go!

The moment you hold this marvel in your hands, you're struck by the large screen and glossy black exterior. Measuring 17 x 7.4 x 2.3 cm and weighing just 280 gm, the PSP is a tad bulky and not really convenient for carrying around in your trouser pocket! The screen apart, the front panel sports directional buttons, with an analogue stick on the left and four control buttons on the right.

The tiny stereo speakers are placed at the bottom edges of the screen, but we'd advise you to use the bundled earphones for better audio.

Below the speakers, you'll find smaller buttons for 'Home', volume, screen brightness, 'Sound', 'Select' and 'Start'.

The left and right trigger buttons are placed on either side at the top. Made of clear plastic, they look part of the design, and it takes a while to realise they're buttons!

A power-cum-hold switch is placed on the right whereas the Wi-Fi switch is located on the left of the device. Yes, it has 802.11b wireless integrated, which lets you play multiplayer games with another PSP! You can find the mini-USB connector and an eject button for the UMD slot on the top as well.

Apart from playing games, you can use the PSP to watch videos (MPEG-4 format), view images and listen to MP3s. It has an MS Duo Pro card slot. A 32 MB card is included with the package but is hardly enough to store anything substantial. The memory card is also used to store game



data such as user preferences, saved games and more. The 4.3-inch widescreen LCD can display 16.77 million colours, and is easily the best feature of the device.

The playing experience is amazing and the PSP feels perfectly balanced when held in both hands in the playing position. It also uses the proprietary 1.8GB Universal Media Disk (UMD) on which more games and now, even movies are available. These mini disks are enclosed in a plastic casing inserted in the UMD drive at the top rear. We tried a few sample games including the *Ridge Racer*—its great graphics and immersive soundtrack kept us at it for hours.

The PSP is powered by a user replaceable 1800 mAh Li-ion battery that can be charged using the bundled AC adaptor. You can expect about three hours of continuous gameplay, depending upon the screen brightness and audio levels.

Overall, the PSP is a great device for portable gaming, but does not excel as a multimedia player. The high cost of the device and UMD disks may deter many buyers, except for the hardcore gamers.

Company **Milestone Interactive Software Ltd**

Price **Rs 19,990 (Games on UMD - Rs 2999)**

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Rating



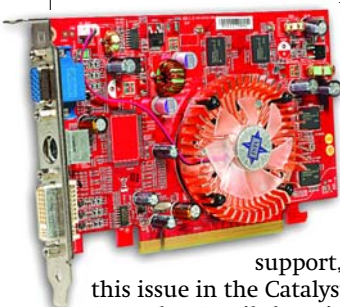
MSI RX1300 Pro 256 MB

Finally, ATi has brought out a graphics card supporting the Shader Model 3.0. The RX1300 Pro is based on the budget-oriented X1300, part of the new 1XK series. Manufactured using the 90 nm fabrication process, it has an entirely new architecture. ATi has implemented Ultra-Threading technology, which distributes the workload efficiently among numerous shaders.

It is CrossFire (a multi-GPU system) ready, just in case your hunger for graphics happens to grow. It also has the AVIVO display platform, which improves video playback quality.

In *Doom 3*, it scored just over half of what a GeForce 6600 scores. In *FarCry*, it came close to the GeForce 6600. But in *3DMark05*, the RX1300 finally outgunned the GeForce 6600, scoring 2,598.

ATi has had weak OpenGL support, but it has promised to address this issue in the Catalyst 5.11 drivers, due for release this November. Until then, it is best to wait and watch if this hot new card will really be the GeForce 6600 killer.



Company **Micro-Star International**

Price **Rs 8,000**

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Rating



ACi Securezza

In The Name Of Security

The Securezza from ACi is a business laptop targeted at the security-conscious. Inside lies an Intel Pentium M 2.0 GHz, 512 MB of 333 MHz DDR RAM, and a 60 GB hard drive.

The 14-inch widescreen display supports 1280 x 768. On the connectivity front, there's high-speed Wi-Fi IEEE 802.11 b+g, a Gigabit LAN port, and integrated Bluetooth. A PCMCIA Type-II slot is present along with a slot for an SD memory card. It also has a fingerprint swipe sensor and a swivel camera!

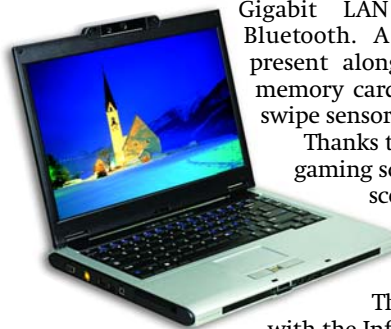
Thanks to the GeForce 6400 Go, the gaming scores were high. It also scored well in ZD-Bench

Business Winstone 2004.

The battery, however, lasted only 98 minutes.

The notebook comes loaded with the Infineon Security Platform

Solution software, a comprehensive toolset that provides additional security to this TCG (Trusted Computing Group) compliant laptop.



Company **Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt. Ltd.**

Price **Rs 84,999**

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Rating

